

Project Design Phase

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Item	Detail
Project	Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform	ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)
Phase	3 - Project Design
Purpose	Describe the solution architecture, process flow and configuration.

1. Solution Overview

A Flow Designer flow is triggered from the Service Catalog for the Standard Laptop item. After approval it creates a Catalog Task against the Requested Item, sets the descriptions and assigns the task to the Hardware group. The flow is linked to the item on its Process Engine tab.

2. Process Flow



3. Components

Component	Role in the design
Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop	Entry point for the user.
Flow: Standard Laptop Task	Contains the trigger and the Create Catalog Task action.
Maintain Items > Process Engine	Connects the flow to the catalog item.
Approval	Gate that must be passed before the task is created.
Catalog Task	Work item for the Hardware team.

4. Flow Design

Element	Setting
Flow name	Standard Laptop Task
Application	Global
Run as	System User
Trigger	Service Catalog (limited to the Standard Laptop item)
Approval step	Ask for Approval before task creation (recommended)
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request Item	Requested Item record from the trigger (drag and drop)

Element	Setting
Table	Catalog Task (auto-populated)
Short description	Laptop needs to be configured
Description	Laptop needs to be configured
Assignment group	Hardware

5. Key Design Decisions

Decision	Reason
Create the task only after approval	The Service Catalog trigger fires when the request is submitted, so an approval step is needed for the task to follow approval.
Limit the trigger to Standard Laptop	Prevents the flow from running for unrelated requests.
Run as System User	Task creation does not depend on the requester's permissions.
Use one flow name	Makes the flow easy to find when attaching it to the item.
Leave the task Approval field out	Not needed; approval is tracked on the Requested Item.

6. Alternative Implementation

The same design is also delivered as three scripted business rules: **Request Approval** (creates the approval), **Approval Rollup** (updates the Requested Item when approved or rejected) and **Create Configuration Task** (creates the Hardware task, without duplicates). These can be installed with the background scripts supplied with the project.

7. Error and Edge Cases

- Rejected approval: no task is created.
- Duplicate protection: the task is not created twice for the same Requested Item.
- Missing Hardware group: the task would have no group, so the group must exist before go-live.